

The Stuck-Loop *Map*.

You can't break a pattern you can't see. Map one loop — just one — and find the cheapest place to interrupt it.

NAME THE LOOP IN ONE SENTENCE — SPECIFIC AND UNFLATTERING

I keep _____ instead of _____ .

01

The trigger

What reliably comes right before the loop fires? A feeling, a time, a situation?

02

The story

What do you tell yourself that makes waiting feel reasonable? Write it word-for-word.

03

The payoff

The uncomfortable one: what is staying stuck paying you? Safety? Rest? Being right about how hard it is?

04

The cost

And what is the loop quietly taking from you while it runs?

Worked example. Loop: "I keep researching instead of starting." Trigger: an open evening with no plan. Story: "I just need a bit more information first." Payoff: I never have to find out if I'd fail. Cost: a year of standing still. Interruption: when I notice the "more information" story, I do two minutes of the real thing.

PICK ONE INTERRUPTION

The smallest move that breaks the circuit at the trigger or the story — not the whole goal. Small, specific, repeatable.

When I notice _____ , I will _____ .